

Order Araneae continued

Family Lycosidae

Wolf spiders

Occurrence 2,400 spp. worldwide, even in Arctic regions; mostly on ground, among leaf litter

Habitat All terrestrial

Wolf spiders are $\frac{5}{32}$ – $1\frac{1}{2}$ in (0.4–4 cm) long and have excellent eyesight, which helps them in their nocturnal hunts. They are pale gray to dark brown, with markings such as bands, stripes, or spots. Females often carry their egg sacs attached to their spinnerets or, in burrowing species, keep the sacs in a silk-lined burrow. They carry spiderlings on their backs. Some wolf spiders are important predators in field ecosystems. This family includes the true tarantula, *Lycosa tarentula*, of southern Europe.



PARDOSA AMENTATA
This European species is variable in appearance—the abdomen, for example, may be brown or gray.

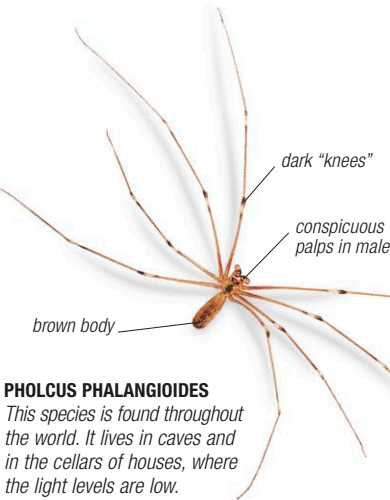
Family Pholcidae

Daddy longlegs spiders

Occurrence 1,000 spp. worldwide; in caves, leaf litter, dark corners of buildings

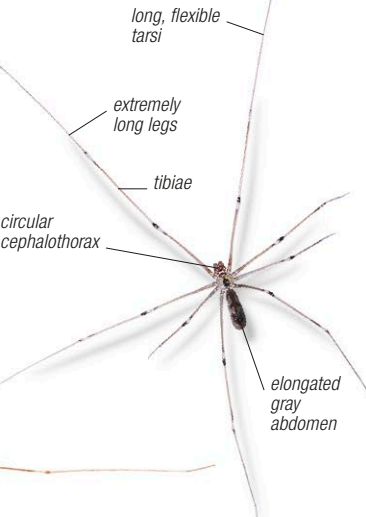


Pale legs that are much longer than the body give these spiders a spindly appearance. Colored gray, green, or brown, they have eyes arranged in 2 groups of 3 each, with another pair in between; a few cave-dwelling species, however, are blind. These spiders are



PHOLCUS PHALANGIOIDES
This species is found throughout the world. It lives in caves and in the cellars of houses, where the light levels are low.

$\frac{1}{8}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ in (3–14 mm) long and have flexible tarsi, with many false joints. Also known as cellar spiders, daddy longlegs spiders make tangled, irregular webs and quickly wrap prey in silk before biting it. When disturbed, they vibrate their webs rapidly, making themselves appear blurred and difficult to spot. Females carry 15–20 pale, pinkish gray eggs, held with silk, in their chelicerae.



PHOLCUS SP.
These spiders inhabit caves, rock crevices, and buildings, especially in warmer regions. They all look very similar, and can be separated only by examination of their genitalia.

Family Pisauridae

Nursery-web spiders

Occurrence 300 spp. worldwide; on ground, surface of still water, aquatic plants

Habitat All

These large spiders resemble wolf spiders (see left) in appearance and hunting technique—running and catching prey on the ground rather than using webs. The carapace is oval and has longitudinal markings; the body is $\frac{3}{8}$ –1 in (1–2.6 cm) long. The females carry the egg sacs in their chelicerae slung below the body, placing them in tentlike nursery webs at hatching time. The sacs and spiderlings are guarded by the females until the second molt, when they leave the web and disperse.



PISAURA MIRABILIS
Found in the pastures and woods of Europe, often among leaf litter, this is a common, ground-living spider.

Family Scytodidae

Spitting spiders

Occurrence 200 spp. worldwide, except Australia and New Zealand; under rocks, in buildings



The common name of these 6-eyed spiders comes from their unique prey-capturing technique. Using a rapid side-to-side movement of the chelicerae, they squirt 2 zigzag streams of sticky, glue-like substance from close range to stick the prey down. Spitting spiders measure $\frac{5}{32}$ – $\frac{3}{8}$ in (4–12 mm)

long and are cream or yellow-brown with black markings. Females carry the egg sacs under their body until the young emerge.



SCYTODES THORACICA
Often found inside buildings in North America and Europe, this spider can squirt glue over $\frac{3}{8}$ in (1 cm). Males are slightly smaller than females.

Family Sicariidae

Six-eyed crab spiders

Occurrence 124 spp. in warm parts of North and South America, Europe, Africa; in shaded areas in rocks and bark



Also known as brown spiders because of their color, these arachnids have 6 eyes, arranged in 3 pairs, and a distinctly hairy body and legs. They are $\frac{1}{4}$ – $\frac{3}{4}$ in (0.6–1.8 cm) long and, in most species, have a violin-shaped mark on the carapace. They make sticky, sheetlike webs, to which some species keep adding as they grow. Females lay

30–300 eggs per sac and keep the sacs at the rear of the web. The bite of these spiders can be very dangerous, causing tissue degeneration.



LOXOSCELES RUFESCENS
Common in Europe and introduced to Australia, the brown recluse spider may bite humans and cause unpleasant lesions that are slow to heal.

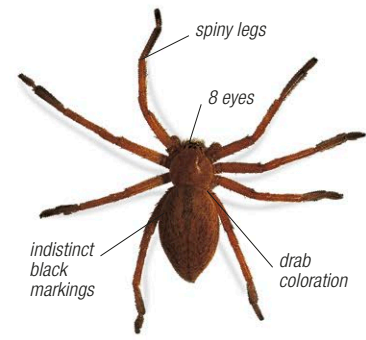
Family Sparassidae

Huntsman spiders

Occurrence 1,000 spp. in tropical and subtropical regions; on ground, tree trunks



These drably colored spiders are efficient, nocturnal hunters, able to move sideways with great agility. The larger species, also known as giant crab spiders, can easily tackle lizards. The carapace and abdomen are flattened. Legs may span up to 6 in (15 cm) and the body can be $\frac{3}{8}$ –2 in (1–5 cm) long. There are 8 eyes of equal size, 4 of which point forward from the front edge of the carapace.



HETEROPODA SPP.
Huntsman spiders are pantropical species. Often found in crates of bananas, they are known to bite warehouse workers but are not dangerous.

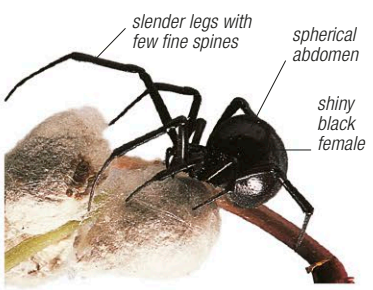
Family Theridiidae

Comb-footed spiders

Occurrence 2,000 spp. worldwide; in vegetation, under stones, in leaf litter, cracks, crevices



Also called cobweb spiders, these brown to black arachnids have a comblike row of stout bristles on their hindlegs. The body is $\frac{1}{16}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ in (0.2–1.5 cm) long and has a very rounded abdomen. Comb-footed spiders construct irregular webs, some of which may have sticky lines extending to the ground. Females are venomous and a few, such as the black widow, are dangerous to humans. They lay up to 1,000 eggs per year, which they often guard in round, silk egg sacs.



LATRODECTUS MACTANS
The male of this species often dies shortly after mating and may be eaten by the venomous female; hence the common name, black widow.